

E-Bike Conversion Kits

Turn any bike into an e-bike for a fraction of the price of a new one.

What It Is

A bolt-on motor kit that converts a regular bicycle into an electric bike. A small motor attaches to the wheel (or bottom bracket) with a battery and throttle/controller, giving any existing bike electric assist without buying a whole new \$1,500+ e-bike. You sell the kits, and optionally offer local installation as an add-on.

How It Makes Money

DTC product sales of the kits online, plus an optional install/service business locally. Buyers are commuters, students, delivery riders, and recreational cyclists who want the e-bike experience at a third of the cost. Money comes from kit sales, premium battery upgrades, accessories (extra batteries, displays, chargers), and install labor for customers who don't want to wrench it themselves.

Startup Costs

- Inventory from Alibaba: e-bike conversion kits, ~\$80–\$180/unit landed depending on motor wattage and battery; start with 10 units = \$1,000–\$1,800
- Sample/test kit to install yourself: \$150
- Shopify + domain: ~\$30/month
- Product photos/video + a demo bike: \$0–\$200
- Basic tools for install service (optional): \$100–\$200
- Packaging/shipping supplies: \$100
- **Total to start: \$1,200–\$2,500**

Alibaba sourcing: search "ebike conversion kit" or "electric bike hub motor kit." Order a 250W–500W front/rear hub kit with battery; test fitment and range before committing to a bulk order. Confirm the motor wattage is street-legal in your market.

The Numbers

- Cost per kit landed: ~\$130 (mid-range with battery)
- Sell price: **\$299–\$449** (average \$349)
- Profit per kit: ~\$200+
- Add install service: charge \$80–\$150 labor at near-pure profit
- Realistic monthly: sell 20 kits/month × \$200 = **\$4,000**, plus 10 installs × \$100 = \$1,000 → ~\$5,000/month. Scale via paid ads and bike-shop wholesale.

How To Start

1. Order 1–2 sample kits and install on your own bike; document range, speed, and ease of install.
2. Confirm local legality for motor wattage and assist class.
3. Build a Shopify store with a clear "fits most bikes" compatibility guide and an install how-to video.

4. Shoot before/after riding footage — pedaling hard vs. cruising effortlessly is the hook.
5. Place a bulk order of 10–20 kits once your sample proves reliable.
6. Offer local installation as a paid add-on to capture non-DIY buyers.
7. Pitch local bike shops on wholesaling kits or referring install jobs.

Where To Get Customers

- TikTok/Instagram/YouTube riding-demo and install videos
- Google Shopping + search ads for "e-bike conversion kit"
- Reddit r/ebikes and commuter/cycling forums
- Local bike shops (wholesale + install referrals)
- Food-delivery rider communities (Uber Eats/DoorDash cyclists)

Pro Tips

- Sell the math, not the motor — "\$349 vs. \$1,800 for a new e-bike" converts far better than torque specs.
- Stock extra batteries as a high-margin repeat purchase; the kit is the razor, the battery is the blade.
- Always demo legality and a real range test in your content — addressing "is it legal / how far does it go" upfront kills the two biggest buyer objections.